

CRAM SHEET

Bladder & Kidney Channels – Week 5

67 + 27 = 94 points · Foot-Taiyang & Foot-Shaoyin

Quiz Ready · Posterior Circuit Complete

BLADDER

67 pts · Water/Yang
3–5 PM · 5 branches

KIDNEY

27 pts · Water/Yin
5–7 PM · 3 branches

CIRCUIT

Posterior/Inner done:
HT+SI+BL+KI

+ trap notes, confusable pairs, Back-Shu series, and full special-points map inside

BL PATHWAY — 5 branches

1. Inner canthus -> vertex
2. vertex -> temple
3. vertex -> bladder
4. lumbar region -> popliteal fossa
5. posterior neck -> little toe

1st: BL1 Jingming · Last: BL67 Zhiyin

BL SPECIAL POINTS

Jing-Well: BL67 Zhiyin
 Ying-Spring: BL66 Zutonggu
 Shu-Stream: BL65 Shugu
 Jing-River: BL60 Kunlun
 He-Sea: BL40 Weizhong
 Yuan-Source: BL64 Jinggu
 Luo-Connecting: BL58 Feiyang
 Xi-Cleft: BL63 Jinmen
 Front-Mu (of Bladder): CV3 Zhongji
 Back-Shu (of Bladder): BL28 Pangguangshu
 Command Point (back): BL40 Weizhong

BL BACK-SHU SERIES (BL13-BL28) — organ transport points

BL13 Lung · BL14 Pericardium · BL15 Heart · BL18 Liver · BL19 Gallbladder · BL20 Spleen · BL21 Stomach · BL22 San Jiao · BL23 Kidney · BL25 Large Intestine · BL27 Small Intestine · BL28 Bladder

QUICK FACTS

BL: Water/Yang · peak 3 PM – 5 PM · pertains Bladder, connects Kidney · paired with KI · Front-Mu CV3 (Zhongji) · Back-Shu BL28 (Pangguangshu)

KI: Water/Yin · peak 5 PM – 7 PM · pertains Kidney, connects Bladder · paired with BL · Front-Mu GB25 (Jingmen) · Back-Shu BL23 (Shenshu)

BL FUNCTION LOGIC

Running-course function:

Two branches cross the head/brain -> headache. Two long parallel lines run the entire back -> low back pain, calf pain, stiff leg, sciatica-type pain along the pathway.

Internal-organ function:

Pertains to the Bladder -> urination disorders. Dr. Zhang notes acupuncture is particularly effective for urinary retention — cites a clinical case where a single point resolved the presentation.

Back-Shu bridge function:

BL13-BL28 are the Back-Shu (transport) points for all twelve zang-fu organs, so BL is also the channel you reach for to treat any other organ system via its associated Back-Shu point (e.g., BL13 Lung, BL15 Heart, BL18 Liver, BL20 Spleen, BL21 Stomach, BL23 Kidney, BL25 Large Intestine, BL27 Small Intestine, BL28 Bladder).

KI PATHWAY — 3 branches

1. Small toe -> kidney -> bladder (main pathway)
2. kidney (re-emerging) -> root of the tongue
3. lung -> Pericardium Meridian

1st: KI1 Yongquan · Last: KI27 Shufu

KI SPECIAL POINTS

Jing-Well: KI1 Yongquan
 Ying-Spring: KI2 Rangu
 Shu-Stream: KI3 Taixi
 Jing-River: KI7 Fuliu
 He-Sea: KI10 Yingu
 Yuan-Source: KI3 Taixi
 Luo-Connecting: KI4 Dazhong
 Xi-Cleft: KI5 Shuiquan
 Front-Mu (of Kidney): GB25 Jingmen
 Back-Shu (of Kidney): BL23 Shenshu
 Confluent (opens Yinqiao Mai): KI6 Zhaohai

KI FUNCTION LOGIC

Running-course function:

Pathway curves behind the medial malleolus/heel -> heel pain (Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical cue). Terminates at the tongue root -> dry mouth, sore throat, tongue-root diagnostic signs.

Internal-organ function:

Kidney stores Essence (Jing) and grasps Qi (governs respiration at its root) — treats asthma-type presentations because the channel connects internally with the Lung. Also governs water metabolism, bone, marrow, and hearing.

BL TRAP NOTES

- TRAP: BL does NOT connect to the Lung. Do not confuse with LU or the Metal-element pathway — BL's internal connection is Kidney only (confirmed midterm-era trap note).
- The two parallel lines on the back (1.5 cun and 3 cun lateral to the spine) run SIMULTANEOUSLY, not as a sequential loop. Dr. Zhang confirmed in Q&A: a student asked whether the back line travels down, back up, and down again, or runs both lines at the same time — answer: "at the same time." Do not draw it as one line doubling back.
- BL has 14 cross-points total, shared with two other channels: the Governor Vessel (GV) and the Gallbladder (GB) channel, concentrated around the head. You are not expected to know each of the 14 individually — only that BL shares crossing points with GV and GB.
- BL7 (Tongtian) is NOT the vertex-joining point — that is GV20 (Baihui), which BL merely joins at the vertex.

COMMONLY CONFUSED POINTS

BL60 vs BL62/BL63:

BL60 Kunlun (Jing-River, mid-Achilles) sits above BL62 Shenmai (Confluent, directly below malleolus) and BL63 Jinmen (Xi-Cleft, anterior-inferior to BL62). All three cluster around the lateral ankle — map them from the malleolus outward.

KI3 vs KI7:

KI3 Taixi = Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source, in the malleolus/Achilles depression. KI7 Fuli = Jing-River, 2 cun proximal to KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.

KI6 vs KI7:

KI6 Zhaohai (Confluent, Yinqiao Mai, below the malleolus) is functionally distinct from KI7 Fuli (Jing-River, tonifies Yang) despite being nearby.

BL40 vs BL54 vs BL57:

All are leg/thigh points on the same posterior line: BL40 Weizhong (popliteal crease, He-Sea/Command) -> BL54 Zhibian (upper thigh/sacrum) -> BL57 Chengshan (calf belly, 8 cun below BL40). Sequence matters for the running-course quiz format.

BL CLINICAL PEARLS

- BL40 (Weizhong): He-Sea, Command point for the back; clears summer-heat; low back pain.
- Back-Shu points (BL13-BL28): organ transport points — treat the corresponding zang-fu organ directly from the back.
- BL60 (Kunlun): called the "aspirin of acupuncture" — headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor.
- BL67 (Zhiyin): corrects fetal malposition with moxibustion; used for labor induction.
- BL62 (Shenmai) and BL63 (Jinmen) sit close together on the lateral foot below the malleolus — BL62 is the Confluent point (opens Yang Qiao Mai); BL63 is the Xi-Cleft.

KI TRAP NOTES

- CLINICAL TEACHING POINT (Dr. Zhang, verbatim emphasis): heel pain — think Kidney first. The channel curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel, and this is called out explicitly as a common clinical presentation.
- KI intersects the Spleen channel at SP6 (Sanyinjiao) on the medial leg — a shared crossing point, not a KI-numbered point.
- Do not confuse KI3 (Taixi, Yuan-source AND Shu-stream — a dual role) with KI7 (Fuli, Jing-river). Both sit near the medial malleolus/Achilles tendon: KI3 is in the depression between the malleolus tip and the Achilles tendon; KI7 is 2 cun above KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.
- KI6 (Zhaohai) is the Confluent point opening the Yinqiao Mai (Yin Heel Vessel) — do not mix up with KI7, which is a Jing-river (five-transport) point with a different clinical profile.

KI CLINICAL PEARLS

- KI1 (Yongquan): Jing-Well; resuscitation, calms the spirit; used in hypertension.
- KI3 (Taixi): Yuan-source; the key tonic point for Kidney Yin AND Yang.
- KI6 (Zhaohai): Confluent (Yinqiao Mai); insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation.
- KI7 (Fuli): tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats (often paired with HT6).
- KI27 (Shufu): final point of the channel, inferior border of the clavicle — links functionally into the chest before the Pericardium channel begins.

BL — all 67

BL1	Jingming	BL15	Xinshu	BL29	Zhonglvshu	BL43	Gaohuang	BL57	Chengshan
BL2	Zanzhu	BL16	Dushu	BL30	Baihuanshu	BL44	Shentang	BL58	Feiyang
BL3	Meichong	BL17	Geshu	BL31	Shangliao	BL45	Yixi	BL59	Fuyang
BL4	Quchai	BL18	Ganshu	BL32	Ciliao	BL46	Geguan	BL60	Kunlun
BL5	Wuchu	BL19	Danshu	BL33	Zhongliao	BL47	Hunmen	BL61	Pucan
BL6	Chengguang	BL20	Pishu	BL34	Xialiao	BL48	Yanggang	BL62	Shenmai
BL7	Tongtian	BL21	Weishu	BL35	Huiyang	BL49	Yishe	BL63	Jinmen
BL8	Luoque	BL22	Sanjiaoshu	BL36	Chengfu	BL50	Weicang	BL64	Jinggu
BL9	Yuzhen	BL23	Shenshu	BL37	Yinmen	BL51	Huangmen	BL65	Shugu
BL10	Tianzhu	BL24	Qihai	BL38	Fuxi	BL52	Zhishi	BL66	Zutonggu
BL11	Dazhu	BL25	Dachangshu	BL39	Weiyang	BL53	Baohuang	BL67	Zhiyin
BL12	Fengmen	BL26	Guanyuanshu	BL40	Weizhong	BL54	Zhibian		
BL13	Feishu	BL27	Xiaochangshu	BL41	Fufen	BL55	Heyang		
BL14	Jueyinshu	BL28	Pangguangshu	BL42	Pohu	BL56	Chengjin		

KI — all 27

KI1	Yongquan	KI7	Fulu	KI13	Qixue	KI19	Yindu	KI25	Shencang
KI2	Rangu	KI8	Jiaoxin	KI14	Siman	KI20	Futonggu	KI26	Yuzhong
KI3	Taixi	KI9	Zhubin	KI15	Zhongzhu	KI21	Youmen	KI27	Shufu
KI4	Dazhong	KI10	Yingu	KI16	Huangshu	KI22	Bulang		
KI5	Shuiquan	KI11	Henggu	KI17	Shangqu	KI23	Shenfeng		
KI6	Zhaohai	KI12	Dahe	KI18	Shiguan	KI24	Lingxu		

COURSE MILESTONE

Week 5 completes the Posterior Circuit (also called Inner Circuit on earlier slide versions): HT and SI (Week 4) plus BL and KI (this week) form the full four-channel posterior/inner circuit. Dr. Zhang's own framing at the end of Lecture 5: "until now, we have learned the posterior circuit, and four meridians consist of the posterior circuit."